

below. You will notice that you eliminated writing the `print: function { }` to define a method.

```
let payroll = {
  _employees: [],
  print() {
    console.log(JSON.stringify(employee));
  }
};
payroll.print();

Output:
{"firstname":"Janardan","lastname":"Revuru","organization":"HP
EG India R&D"}
```

The full code snippet is available at <http://www.es6fiddle.net/iedsjdz/>

Table 2
(None: 0 per cent; Full: 100 per cent)

	Non-browser environment			Browsers (stable version)	
Feature	io.js 3.0.0	Babel	node.js 0.12.0	Chrome 44	Firefox 40
Binary, octal literals	Full	Full	Full	Full	Full
Enhanced object literals	Full	Full	None	Full	Full

Why learn JavaScript?

In the crowded space in which new programming languages emerge every year, with each 'selling' itself as the best ever in the history of computing, how can programmers decide or choose between them?

Over the years, what I have learnt is, it is not the most elegant and feature-rich language that survives the test of time. For a language to continue being in use, there are many factors that come into play. JavaScript has stood the test of time, to some extent, on the basis of its own merits and partly due to luck.

JavaScript does have its share of imperfections. But the sheer omnipresent nature of the JavaScript environment inside browsers on different platforms makes it the most used. With ES6, there are enough reasons to make JavaScript more compiler and translator friendly. This will enable the bulk of programs already written in languages like C/C++ to be translated to JavaScript to run in the browser environment. Some examples are the GWT compiler that translates Java source to JavaScript source, and Sharp# which converts the JavaScript environment. For a list of languages that compile to JavaScript, visit <https://github.com/jashkenas/coffeescript/wiki/List-of-languages-that-compile-to-JS>. So even if you are a non-JavaScript programmer, who wants your application to run in a browser environment, it is essential you understand the fundamental capabilities and limitations of the language.

If you are a graduate out of college or in the early years of your software career, you can bet your career on JavaScript—as some sort of 'one language that fits all purposes', be it developing hobby mobile apps or enterprise class applications. JavaScript has made inroads into the server side too. Thanks to node.js and JSON data interchange, now server side programmers and client side programmers talk the same language! They also exchange data in common JSON format.

To know more about the layers JavaScript is striving, log on to the URL mentioned in Reference 3.

Next month we will cover computed property keys and String functions in ES6. 

References

- [1] 'Play around with ES6 features online'; <http://www.es6fiddle.net/>
- [2] 'Languages that compile to JavaScript' <https://github.com/jashkenas/coffeescript/wiki/List-of-languages-that-compile-to-JS>
- [3] 'An Introduction to Full-Stack JavaScript'; <http://www.smashingmagazine.com/2013/11/introduction-to-full-stack-javascript/>

By: Janardan Revuru

The author works at HP EG India R&D in Bengaluru. He is passionate about JavaScript and related Web frameworks.

THE COMPLETE MAGAZINE ON OPEN SOURCE

OpenSource
ForYou

Your favourite Magazine on Open Source is now on the Web, too.

OpenSourceForU.com

Follow us on Twitter@LinuxForYou